

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 10 · EDUCATION

Reading

B1+/B2

One Size Doesn't Fit All · The Conversation Nobody Speaks

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'one size doesn't fit all' means about education?

2. Which do you think you'd prefer as a student: a strict, exam-focused school or a flexible, student-centred one? Why?

One Size Doesn't Fit All

- 1 Walk into a classroom in one country and you might see rows of silent students copying notes from a board. Walk into a classroom elsewhere, and you might find children sitting in a circle, designing their own project for the week. Neither approach is automatically wrong; each simply grew out of different beliefs about how learning works best.
- 2 Traditional, exam-focused systems often exist because they can be measured easily and applied to large numbers of students at once. Since a single national test can be marked quickly and compared fairly, many governments rely on it, even though critics argue it encourages rote learning rather than real understanding. Such systems can be so exam-driven that students learn to answer questions without ever asking their own.
- 3 Student-centred methods, on the other hand, grew popular due to research suggesting that motivation and self-discipline improve when learners have real choices. A student who picks their own topic is often so engaged that they keep researching long after the lesson ends. The challenge is that this approach demands well-trained teachers and smaller classes — resources not every school can afford.

185 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
 - a) Traditional education is always better than student-centred education.
 - b) Different education systems grew out of different beliefs and goals, each with strengths and challenges.
 - c) Exams should be removed from every education system.
2. Traditional, exam-focused systems are popular partly because they can be _____ easily.
3. According to the text, why do student-centred methods appeal to some educators?
 - a) They are cheaper to run than traditional schools.
 - b) Research suggests motivation and self-discipline improve when learners have real choices.
 - c) They remove the need for teachers altogether.
4. According to the text, student-centred methods need no special resources. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
5. Critics argue that heavily exam-driven systems encourage _____ learning rather than real understanding.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Do you think your own school leans more toward the traditional or the student-centred approach?

2. Can you think of a downside of student-centred learning that the text doesn't mention?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you think the title 'The Conversation Nobody Speaks' refers to?

2. Can you think of a gesture that means different things in different cultures?

The Conversation Nobody Speaks

- 1 Long before a person finishes a sentence, their body has usually already said something. Researchers who study communication estimate that a large share of meaning in face-to-face

conversation comes not from words, but from posture, gesture and facial expression. This silent layer of communication can support what someone says — or quietly contradict it.

- 2 Some signals appear to be almost universal. A genuine smile, for example, tends to involve the muscles around the eyes as well as the mouth, which is why a forced smile can look slightly 'off' even to a stranger. Other signals, however, change enormously between cultures. Direct eye contact might suggest confidence and honesty in one country, while in another it can be read as rude or challenging.
- 3 This is exactly why body language must be interpreted carefully, never in isolation. A single crossed-arm gesture doesn't automatically mean someone is angry or closed off; they might simply be cold, or comfortable standing that way. Skilled observers look for clusters of signals and consider the context before drawing any conclusion about what a person really means.

179 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
 - a Body language always means exactly the same thing everywhere.
 - b A large part of communication is non-verbal, but it must be interpreted carefully and in context.
 - c Facial expressions are less important than words.
 2. A genuine smile usually involves the muscles around the eyes as well as the _____.
 3. According to the text, how does eye contact differ across cultures?
 - a It always means the same thing everywhere.
 - b It can suggest confidence in one culture and rudeness in another.
 - c It is never used outside Western countries.
 4. According to the text, a single gesture is always enough to know exactly how someone feels.

☐ Correct
 ☐ Incorrect
-
5. The text says crossed arms don't automatically mean anger — a person might simply be _____.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Why do you think a forced smile can look 'off' to other people?

2. Do you agree that a single gesture is never enough to judge how someone feels? Why or why not?
